

Career Research Worksheet

FOR THE STUDENT

Takes a career from "that sounds cool" to something you actually know about: what the work is, what it pays, what it needs, and whether you would like the day.

When: Any time a career sounds interesting — one sheet per career

Career

Where I heard about it

The facts

*Get these from the Occupational Outlook Handbook or O*NET. Both are free and neither is trying to sell you anything.*

What people in this job actually do all day

Typical pay — starting, and after ten years

Education or licence required

Is the field growing, flat or shrinking?

Where the jobs are — anywhere, or specific places?

The honest part

The part of this job I would genuinely enjoy

The part I would find hard or boring

What kind of person does well at this

Does that sound like me? Why or why not?

How you get in

Majors or programmes that lead here

A cheaper or faster route to the same job (apprenticeship, certificate, community college)

Something I could do this year to test whether I like it

WORTH KNOWING

- ◆ Almost every career has more than one route in. Find the second one before assuming the expensive one is required.
- ◆ Pay ranges vary hugely by region. Look up your own.
- ◆ The best test is a day of shadowing, not a week of reading.